

CUSTOMER

1. Passage anchor

> “...to meet deadlines, handle **customer expectations**, and keep the quality steady every single time.”

Passage meaning

customer = person who buys goods or services from a business

顧客；**客戶**

Here, the speaker means people who would buy the desserts and have expectations about quality, timing, service, and delivery.

Practice

1. Good communication helps manage **customer expectations**.

良好的溝通有助於管理**顧客期望**。

2. Small businesses need to understand what their **customers** want.

小企業需要了解**顧客**想要甚麼。

Core meaning of CUSTOMER

2. customer — buyer of goods or services

= person or organization that buys goods or services from a business

顧客；**客戶**

Examples

1. The shop has many regular **customers**.

這家店有很多固定**顧客**。

2. We always try to help the **customer** quickly.

我們總是盡量迅速幫助**客戶**。

This is the central modern sense.

3. paying customer

= customer who actually pays for a product or service

****付費顧客；付費客戶****

Examples

1. The service is available only to ****paying customers****.

這項服務只提供給****付費顧客****。

2. The business needs enough ****paying customers**** to survive.

生意需要有足夠的****付費客戶****才能維持。

Regular / repeat customer

4. regular customer

= customer who frequently returns to the same business

****熟客；常客****

Examples

1. She became a ****regular customer****.

她成了這家店的****熟客****。

2. The bakery gives small discounts to ****regular customers****.

烘焙店會給****常客****小額折扣。

5. repeat customer

= customer who buys from a business again after an earlier purchase

****回頭客；再次購買的顧客****

Examples

1. Good service creates ****repeat customers****.

良好的服務能帶來****回頭客****。

2. Most of our sales come from ****repeat customers****.

我們大部分銷售都來自****回頭客****。

Business/customer relationship

6. customer base

= total group of people or organizations that regularly or potentially buy from a business

****客戶群；顧客基礎****

Examples

1. The company has a loyal ****customer base****.
公司有一群忠實的****客戶群****。
2. Social media helped the bakery expand its ****customer base****.
社交媒體幫助烘焙店擴大****客群****。

7. customer service

= help and support given to customers before, during, or after a purchase

****客戶服務；顧客服務****

Examples

1. Good ****customer service**** is essential for a small business.
良好的****客戶服務****對小企業很重要。
2. She works in ****customer service****.
她從事****客戶服務****工作。

8. customer support

= assistance provided to customers, especially for problems or questions

****客戶支援****

Examples

1. Contact ****customer support**** if your order is missing.
如果訂單不見了，請聯絡****客戶支援****。
2. The company offers 24-hour ****customer support****.
公司提供二十四小時****客戶支援****。

9. customer experience

= overall experience a customer has with a business or brand

****顧客體驗；客戶體驗****

Examples

1. Fast delivery improves the ****customer experience****.
快速送貨能改善****顧客體驗****。
2. Packaging is part of the overall ****customer experience****.
包裝是整體****客戶體驗****的一部分。

Expectations / satisfaction

10. customer expectations

= standards or results customers expect from a product or service

****顧客期望；客戶期望****

This is the exact passage construction.

Examples

1. Businesses need to manage ****customer expectations****.
企業需要管理****顧客期望****。
2. Clear delivery times help set realistic ****customer expectations****.
清楚的送貨時間有助建立合理的****客戶期望****。

11. customer satisfaction

= degree to which customers are pleased with a product or service

****顧客滿意度****

Examples

1. The company measures ****customer satisfaction**** regularly.
公司定期衡量****顧客滿意度****。
2. Product quality affects ****customer satisfaction****.
產品品質會影響****客戶滿意度****。

Customer as organization/business buyer

12. customer — organization that buys from another business

= company, institution, or organization purchasing products or services

企業客戶；機構客戶

Examples

1. The software company serves large corporate **customers**.

這家軟體公司服務大型企業**客戶**。

2. The supplier lost one of its biggest **customers**.

供應商失去了一個最大的**客戶**。

So a **customer** does not have to be an individual person.

Informal older sense: type of person

13. customer — person of a particular type

Informal, somewhat old-fashioned, usually in fixed descriptions:

= person considered in terms of their character or how difficult they are to deal with

某種性格的人；傢伙

Examples

1. He can be a difficult **customer**.

他有時是個**很難應付的人**。

2. She is one tough **customer**.

她是個**很強悍、不好對付的人**。

This is a genuine but lower-priority sense.

14. tough customer

= person who is strong, difficult to defeat, persuade, or deal with

****強硬的人；難對付的角色****

Examples

1. The negotiator is a ****tough customer****.
那位談判者是個****很難對付的人****。
2. Don't underestimate her—she's a ****tough customer****.
別小看她，她是個****強悍角色****。

15. awkward customer

BrE informal:

= difficult, troublesome, or potentially dangerous person/situation

****難應付的人；棘手角色****

Examples

1. He can be an ****awkward customer**** when he is angry.
他生氣時會變成一個****很難應付的人****。
2. That opponent is an ****awkward customer****.
那個對手是個****棘手角色****。

Lower priority but established.

Related forms

16. custom

Important: ****custom**** is historically related but is now a distinct lexical word with its own meanings:

* tradition/practice → ****習俗****

* made specially → ****訂製****

* regular business → historical basis of ****customer****

Do not treat ordinary ****custom**** senses as simply meanings of ****customer****.

17. customize / customise

= change something to suit a particular customer or user

****客製化；按需要訂製****

Examples

1. Customers can ****customize**** their cake.

顧客可以****客製化****自己的蛋糕。

2. The software can be ****customised**** for different businesses.

軟體可以按不同企業需求****客製化****。

Useful commercial neighbor, though it belongs more directly to ****custom**** than ****customer****.

18. customer-facing

= involving direct interaction with customers

****面向顧客的；直接接觸客戶的****

Examples

1. She works in a ****customer-facing role****.

她從事一份****直接面對顧客的職位****。

2. Staff in ****customer-facing positions**** need strong communication skills.

****直接接觸客戶的職位****需要良好的溝通能力。

High-value distinctions

19. customer vs client

****customer****

= usually buys goods or relatively standardized services

****顧客；客戶****

****client****

= usually receives professional or personalized services

****客戶；委託人****

Compare:

> bakery customer

> 烘焙店顧客

> lawyer's client

> 律師的客戶

There is overlap in modern business English.

20. customer vs consumer

****customer****

= person or organization that buys

****購買者；顧客****

****consumer****

= person who actually uses/consumes the product or service

****消費者****

The customer and consumer may be different.

Example:

> A parent buys cereal for a child.

The parent is the ****customer****.

The child may be the ****consumer****.

21. customer vs buyer

****buyer****

= person who purchases something

****買家；購買者****

****customer****

= broader business relationship; may buy repeatedly and receive service/support

****顧客；客戶****

22. customer vs shopper

****shopper****

= person currently shopping or regularly shopping

****購物者****

****customer****

= person who buys or has a business relationship with the seller

Someone may be a shopper without ultimately becoming a customer.

23. customer vs user

****user****

= person who uses a product/service/system

****使用者****

****customer****

= person/organization paying for it

****客戶****

In software, they may be different people.

Meaning map

The central modern concept of ****customer**** is:

****a person or organization that buys from a business****

From this develop:

Passage

customer expectations

→ ****顧客期望****

Loyalty

regular customer

→ ****熟客****

Repeat business

repeat customer

→ ****回頭客****

Business population

customer base

→ **客戶群**

Support

customer service

→ **客戶服務**

Experience

customer experience

→ **顧客體驗**

A separate informal extension is:

Person type

tough customer

→ **難對付 / 強悍的人**

So **customer** has a smaller meaning inventory than words such as **manage** or **package**, and should not be artificially over-split.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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customer — buyer	向企業購買商品或服務的人 / 機構；顧客 / 客戶
paying customer	實際付費購買商品 / 服務的顧客
regular customer	經常光顧同一商戶的熟客 / 常客
repeat customer	曾購買後再次光顧的回頭客
customer base	某企業現有或穩定的整體客戶群
customer service	企業在購買前後為顧客提供的服務與協助
customer support	幫助顧客解決問題或疑問的客戶支援
customer experience	顧客與企業互動整個過程中的整體體驗
customer expectations	顧客對產品、服務、交付等預期的標準
customer satisfaction	顧客對產品 / 服務感到滿意的程度
customer — organizational buyer	向另一企業購買商品 / 服務的企業或機構客戶
customer — informal person type	非正式：某種性格 / 難度的人或角色
tough customer	強悍、不容易說服、擊敗或應付的人
awkward customer	較棘手、難應付的人
customer-facing	工作內容需要直接與客戶互動的

Passage recap

> “...to meet deadlines, handle **customer expectations**, and keep the quality steady every single time.”

Here:

customer = **a person who buys the business's desserts**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **顧客**

* **客戶**

And:

customer expectations

= **顧客對產品、服務、交貨等方面的期望**

Natural contextual translation:

要準時交貨、處理顧客的期望，以及每次都保持穩定品質。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

customer

= **a person or organization that buys goods or services from a business**

顧客；客戶

The most important distinction is:

> **customer**

> → 買東西 / 服務的人

> **consumer**

> → 實際使用 / 消耗產品的人

> **client**

> → 通常接受專業或個人化服務的客戶

And an unusual informal extension is:

> ****tough customer****

> → ****難對付的強悍人物****

So this is a useful family, but a ****compact one****: its main modern sense remains the commercial ****buyer/customer**** meaning.